# ETCSL 1.8.2.3 — Enmerkar and the lord of Aratta

- **Editors:** ETCSL project, Oxford 1998–2006; composite after Cohen 1973 (*Enmerkar and the Lord of Aratta*, diss.
  Pennsylvania) and Vanstiphout's work (XML header); English translation ETCSL (after Vanstiphout 2003).
- **URLs:** transliteration https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=c.1.8.2.3 ; translation https://etcsl.orinst.ox.ac.uk/cgi-bin/etcsl.cgi?text=t.1.8.2.3 ; ORACC epsd2/literary **Q000369** (`../../ORACC/epsd2-literary--Q000369--Enmerkar-and-the-Lord-of-Aratta/`).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-21 from the local OTA 2518 bulk corpus (`../_bulk/etcsl.zip`, members `etcsl/transliterations/c.1.8.2.3.xml`, `etcsl/translations/t.1.8.2.3.xml`).
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## Content

641 composite entries (1–636 with single-manuscript plus-lines 11A, 106A, 185A, 185B, 365B and the alternative lines A–D for 400–403; no 369, 608–610): the prologue on Uruk and Aratta (1–32);
Enmerkar's plea to Inana (33–64) and her answer (65–104); the first commission of the messenger, with the threat and
the "spell of Nudimmud" (105–155); the journey and the first exchange (156–307); the grain (308–338) and the sceptre
(339–455); the champions and the garments (456–499); **the invention of writing on clay** (500–506); the tablet, the
storm of Iškur and the wild wheat (507–556); Aratta's last answer (557–576); the end (577–636, damaged).

## Files

- `c.1.8.2.3.xml`, `t.1.8.2.3.xml` — ETCSL TEI source.
- `transliteration.md` (641 lines), `translation.md` (paragraphs labelled by line range) — `../../../tools/etcsl2md.py`.

## Line numbering

ETCSL = Cohen 1973 = (mostly) Mittermayer 2009 = ORACC Q000369 (which also numbers single-manuscript lines).

## Usefulness

**Base text** (rank 1, with Mittermayer 2009) of `אגדות-מלכים/1-אנמרכר-ואדון-ארטה/`. The ETCSL English is rank 3: read
it only after forming a reading from the Sumerian; its "may they … address Enlil in a single language" (141–146) and
"shall change the speech" (150–155) decide the Gen 11 question and must be checked against the morphology.